STORYCAST

An Accessible Media Feature Microsite

Research and Planning Documentation

Project: StoryCast An Accessible Media Feature Microsite
Technology: HTML5, Sass/CSS, and optional vanilla JavaScript
Design direction: Dark charcoal background, vivid orange accents, clear typography, and accessible media presentation.

1. Project Overview

StoryCast is a three-page website that is made to help visitors find personal stories and experience them through listening to audio watching videos or reading written transcripts.

The project focuses on showing media in a way that's easy for everyone on having clear structure for information on making layouts that work on all screens and on keeping front-end code easy to maintain.

Project Objectives

- Use HTML5 elements so the page structure has meaning.
- Build layouts that respond to screen changes using CSS Grid and Flexbox.
- Implement least one container query so a component can be reused.
- Organize styles with Sass partials and reusable design tokens.
- Provide captions and transcripts, for all media content.
- Support navigation using the keyboard and show visible focus indicators.
- Create wireframes and detailed mockups before finishing development.

Target Audience

The intended audience includes people who like stories, visitors who prefer listening or watching and people who benefit from transcripts, captions, keyboard navigation or reduced motion.

The design aims to make stories easy to find and comfortable to experience on both desktop and mobile devices.

Design Principles

Clarity: Provide navigation and a predictable experience.page structure.

Accessibility: Prioritize readable text, sufficient contrast, captions, transcripts, and keyboard support.

Consistency: Reuse buttons, cards, spacing, colors, and typography throughout the site.

Responsiveness: Ensure the layout adapts to different screen sizes without horizontal scrolling.

2. Information Architecture

The StoryCast microsite contains three main pages connected through shared navigation and related content.

Sitemap

StoryCast Microsite

- ☑ ~~**Home Page — index.html**~~
  - ☑ ~~Introduction to StoryCast~~
  - ☑ ~~Featured audio and video stories~~
  - ☑ ~~Accessibility highlights~~
  - ☑ ~~Navigation to the other pages~~
- ☑ ~~**Story Detail Page — story/index.html**~~
  - ☑ ~~Story title and author information~~
  - ☑ ~~Story cover image~~
  - ☑ ~~Audio player~~
  - ☑ ~~Video player with captions~~
  - ☑ ~~Written transcript~~
  - ☐ Related stories
- ☑ ~~**About / Accessibility Page — about.html**~~
  - ☑ ~~StoryCast mission~~
  - ☑ ~~Explanation of the platform~~
  - ☑ ~~Accessibility features~~
  - ☑ ~~Information about captions, transcripts, and keyboard access~~

Navigation Relationships

- The Home page links to the Story Detail page through featured story cards.
- The main navigation links to the About / Accessibility page.
- The Story Detail page provides navigation back to Home and links to related stories.
- All pages share a consistent header and footer.

This structure helps users understand where they are and move between the main areas of the website.

3. Wireframes

Wireframes define the layout and hierarchy of content before detailed styling is applied. They help establish the placement of navigation, images, text, media players, and buttons.

3.1 Home Page Wireframe

The Home page contains:

- A header with the StoryCast logo and navigation.
- A hero section with a large image, headline, supporting text, and call-to-action button.
- A Featured Stories section containing three story cards.
- An accessibility section highlighting audio, captions, and transcripts.
- A footer containing navigation and copyright information.

On mobile screens, the story cards stack vertically and the layout adjusts to the narrower viewport.

3.2 Story Detail Page Wireframe

The Story Detail page contains:

- A shared header and navigation.
- The story title, author, and publication date.
- A large cover image.
- An audio player with playback controls.
- A video player with caption support.
- A readable transcript section.
- Related story cards.
- A shared footer.

The media and transcript sections should be easy to find and use on both desktop and mobile screens.

3.3 About / Accessibility Page Wireframe

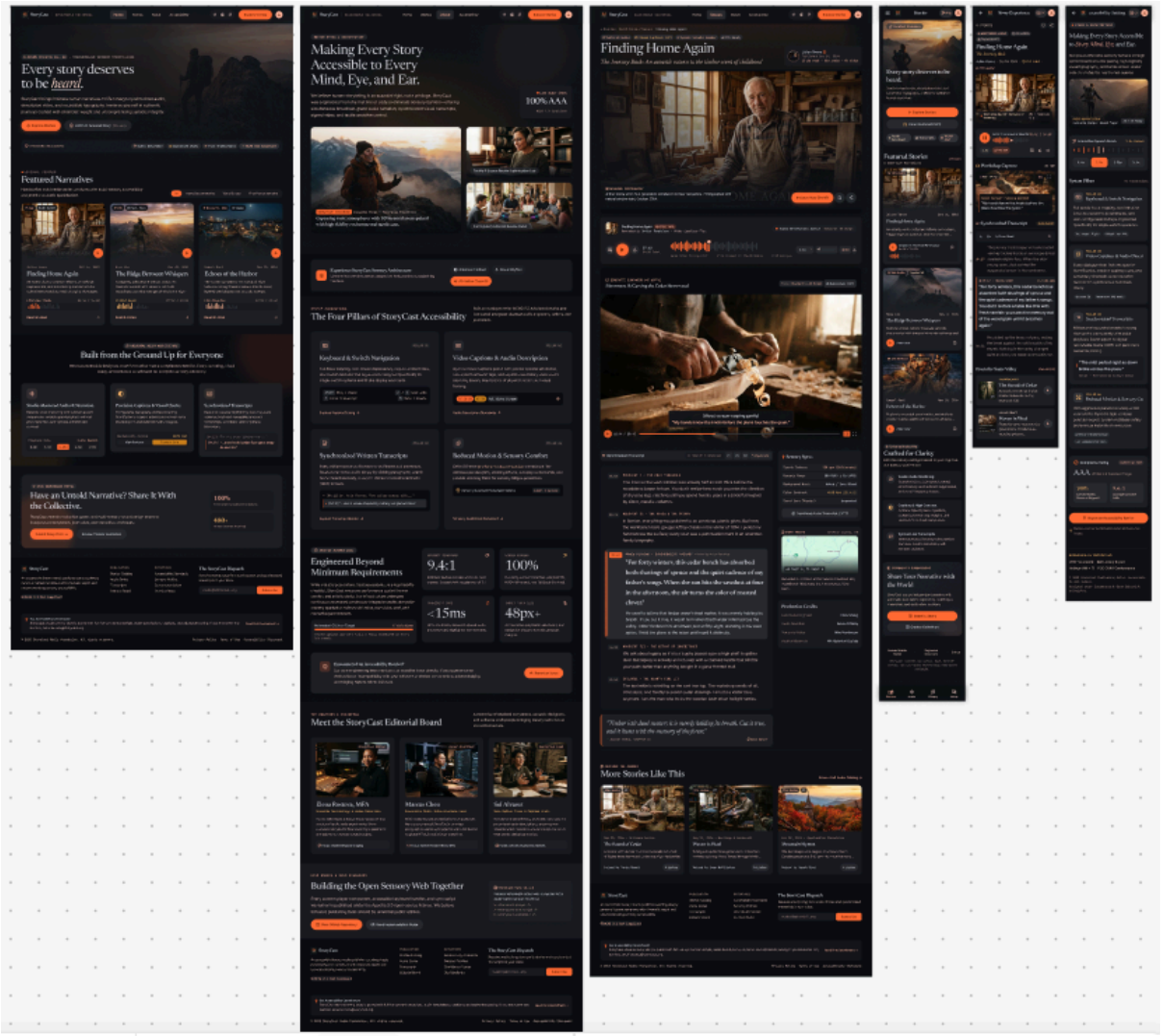
The About / Accessibility page contains:

- A shared header and navigation.
- An introduction to the StoryCast mission.
- A section explaining the platform's purpose.
- Accessibility feature cards describing keyboard navigation, captions, transcripts, and reduced-motion support.
- A shared footer.

The feature cards adapt to smaller screens by stacking vertically.

Wireframe Link

Figma wireframes:
https://www.figma.com/board/sjrwKuaKhA427IzGyyOHfx/low-fidelity-wireframe?node-id=1-1202&t=Wy07pMxBe6Hi1cWc-1



4. High-Fidelity Mockups

High-fidelity mockups apply the visual identity, colors, typography, imagery, and detailed components to the wireframe layouts.

The goal is to establish a consistent design that can be implemented using semantic HTML5 and Sass.

4.1 Visual Design System

The StoryCast visual identity uses a dark editorial style with orange accents.

Design Token	Color Value	Purpose
Background	#111318	Main page background
Surface	#1B1E25	Cards and media panels

Accent	#FF6B35	Buttons and highlights
Main Text	#F5F5F5	Headings and primary text
Secondary Text	#C0C5D0	Supporting text

Typography

A clean sans-serif font is used for readability. Large, bold headings establish visual hierarchy, while body text uses comfortable sizes and spacing.

Components

The reusable components include:

- Header and navigation
- Primary and secondary buttons
- Story cards
- Audio and video media panels
- Transcript panels
- Accessibility feature cards
- Footer

4.2 Home Page Mockup

The Home page introduces StoryCast with the headline:

“Every story deserves to be heard.”

A cinematic landscape image establishes the atmosphere. Featured story cards encourage visitors to explore content, while the accessibility section communicates the site's commitment to inclusive storytelling.

4.3 Story Detail Page Mockup

The Story Detail page focuses on one featured story. It combines story information, audio and video media, captions, and a written transcript in a clear reading order.

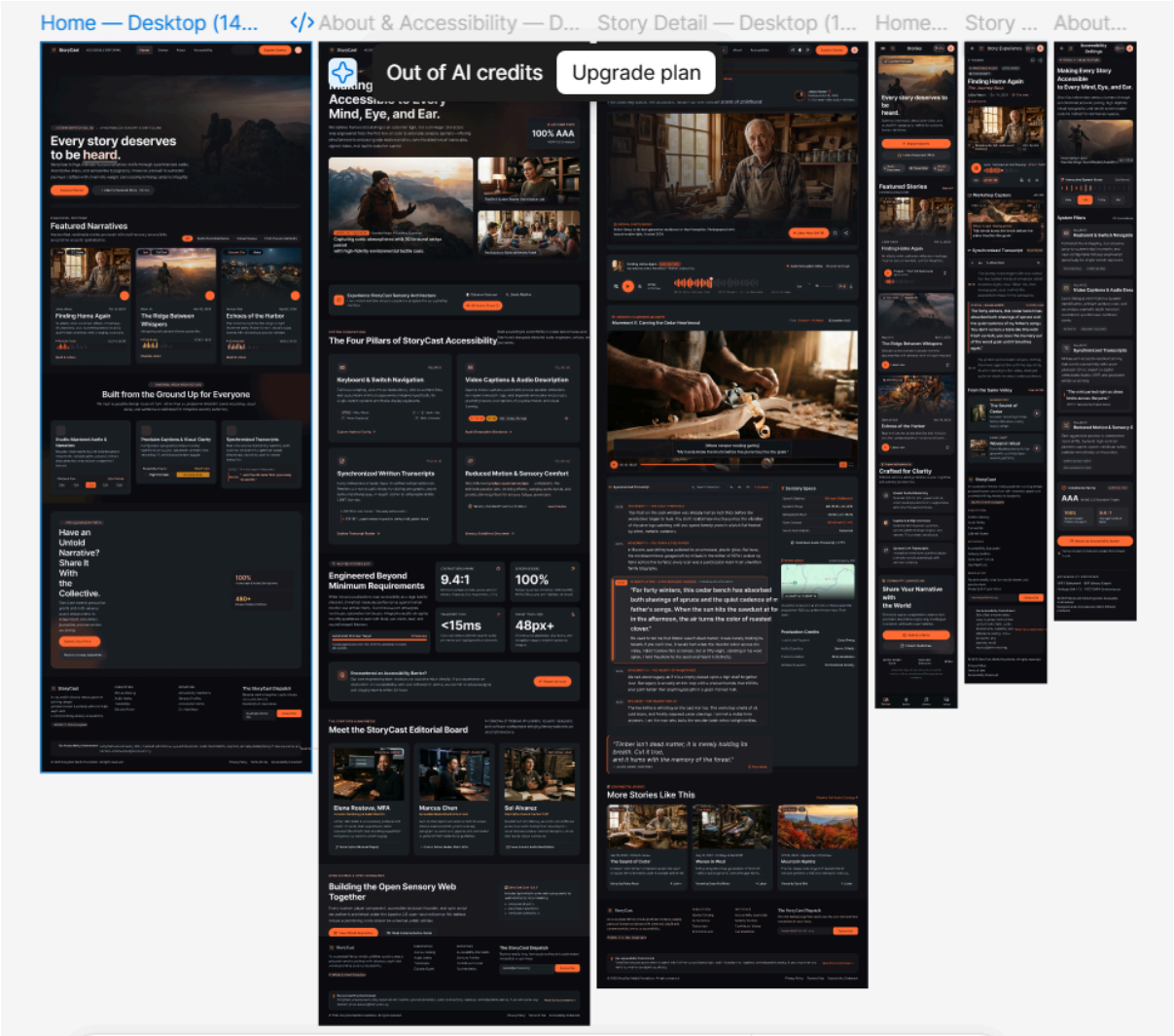
Related stories encourage visitors to continue exploring the site.

4.4 About / Accessibility Page Mockup

This page communicates the StoryCast mission and explains the accessibility features that help people engage with the content in different ways.

High-Fidelity Mockup Link

Figma high-fidelity mockups:
https://www.figma.com/design/CYg5NKzWqt3rG2zjht7T7w/high-fidelity-mockup?node-id=0-1&t=9t2C9wpMDdmzgBGv-1



If the wireframes and mockups are in the same Figma file, the same share link can be used, provided the frames are clearly labeled.

5. Development Plan

StoryCast is designed to use vanilla HTML5, Sass/CSS, and optional JavaScript without a front-end framework.

HTML Structure

Semantic HTML elements such as <header>, <nav>, <main>, <section>, <article>, <figure>, and <footer> provide meaningful structure.

Media elements such as <audio>, <video>, and <track> support the presentation of multimedia content.

Sass Architecture

The Sass structure separates design tokens from shared components and page layouts.

- _colors.scss defines the color palette.
- _typography.scss defines fonts and type sizes.
- _spacing.scss defines spacing, container width, and border-radius tokens.
- _base.scss contains base styles.
- _layout.scss manages page layout and responsive structure.
- _components.scss contains reusable interface components.
- _accessibility.scss contains focus styles and accessibility-related utilities.
- main.scss imports the required Sass modules.

Compiled CSS is stored in the /css directory.

Responsive Design

CSS Grid is used for story and feature grids. Flexbox supports navigation, alignment, and component layouts. Media queries adjust the overall page layout at different viewport widths.

At least one container query allows a reusable component to change its internal layout based on the width of its container.

Media Support

The Story Detail page includes audio and video areas, a captions track for video, and a readable transcript.

The transcript and captions should accurately represent the actual media used on the website.

6. Accessibility Considerations

The project aims to follow WCAG 2.1 Level AA accessibility requirements. Final conformance must be assessed by testing the completed website.

Keyboard Navigation

Interactive elements should be reachable using the keyboard in a logical order. Visible focus indicators help users identify the currently focused element.

Color Contrast

Text and interface elements should have sufficient contrast against their backgrounds. Contrast should be checked using an appropriate contrast-checking tool.

Color alone should not communicate important information.

Captions and Transcripts

Video content with speech should provide accurate captions. Audio and video storytelling should provide readable transcripts for spoken content.

Semantic HTML

Semantic landmarks and a logical heading hierarchy help users navigate the website. Informative images should have meaningful alternative text.

ARIA Attributes

ARIA attributes should be used when necessary to provide information that native HTML does not already communicate. Native semantic HTML should be preferred whenever possible.

Reduced Motion

The design should respect the prefers-reduced-motion setting and avoid unnecessary animation.

Accessibility Testing Checklist

- Test all navigation links and interactive controls.
- Check keyboard navigation and visible focus indicators.
- Verify text and interface contrast.
- Confirm captions and transcripts match the media.
- Test layouts at desktop and mobile widths.
- Check for horizontal scrolling and overlapping content.
- Run available HTML and accessibility validation tools.
- Test the deployed website before submission.

These checks should be completed before claiming that the website conforms to WCAG AA.

7. Project Structure

The planned repository structure is:

```
storycast/
├── index.html
├── about.html
├── README.md
├── story/
│   └── index.html
├── sass/
│   ├── main.scss
│   ├── _colors.scss
│   ├── _typography.scss
│   ├── _spacing.scss
│   ├── _base.scss
│   ├── _layout.scss
│   ├── _components.scss
│   └── _accessibility.scss
├── css/
│   └── main.css
├── assets/
│   ├── images/
│   ├── audio/
│   ├── video/
│   ├── captions/
│   └── transcripts/
└── docs/
    └── StoryCast_Research_Documentation.pdf
```

The project uses Sass for maintainable styling and compiled CSS for browser delivery. The assets directory stores the images, media files, captions, and transcripts used by the microsite.

8. Submission Checklist

The final submission should include:

- A public GitHub repository named storycast.
- The Home, Story Detail, and About / Accessibility pages.
- Sass partials, design tokens, and compiled CSS.
- Media assets, captions, and transcripts.
- A README containing the project overview, structure, local setup instructions, and accessibility checklist.
- This research and planning document in PDF format.
- A sitemap showing the three pages and their relationships.
- A public Figma link to the wireframes.
- A public Figma link to the high-fidelity mockups.
- A deployed website URL that can be opened by the lecturer.

Final Submission Details

GitHub repository:

https://github.com/cashme8/storycast

Live website:

https://cashme8.github.io/storycast/

Figma wireframes:
https://www.figma.com/board/sjrwKuaKhA427IzGyyOHfx/low-fidelity-wireframe?node-id=1-1202&t=Wy07pMxBe6Hi1cWc-1

Figma high-fidelity mockups:
https://www.figma.com/design/CYg5NKzWqt3rG2zjht7T7w/high-fidelity-mockup?node-id=0-1&t=9t2C9wpMDdmzgBGv-1

Conclusion

StoryCast combines accessible storytelling with a clear, responsive, and consistent interface. Its three-page structure helps users discover stories, experience multimedia content, and understand the platform's accessibility approach.

The project brings together information architecture, user-centered design, semantic HTML5, Sass, responsive CSS, and accessibility testing to create a maintainable microsite.